

A CLOUD SAFETY AUDIT



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increases manifold with the addition of hybrid and multiple-cloud models,” says Atul Gupta, Partner and Head of Digital Trust and Cyber Security Services at KPMG in India. “This makes it difficult for organisations to identify and address vulnerabilities in their environments, leaving them more vulnerable.”

This has created the notion that cloud systems are less secure. Not only that, once bad actors identify a vulnerability, they deploy various strategies to exploit it and gain unauthorised access to one or many accounts/systems, from where they can move laterally within the complete cloud environment. This allows them to access critical accounts, services and data. But

this doesn't mean the cloud isn't secure. It is usually as vulnerable or as secure as on-premise infrastructure. What really makes a difference is the cybersecurity frameworks deployed to protect and prevent these systems against attacks.

UNRAVELLING THE ATTACKS

Primarily motivated by financial gain, recognition and visibility, espionage, geopolitical reasons, etc., cyber intruders usually target industries that have large-scale manufacturing or sales operations, or those that deal with sensitive personal information, such as hospitals and financial services firms, or those